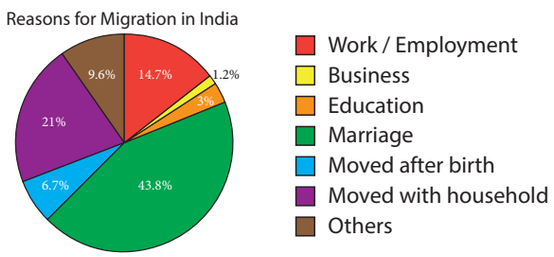
5.2 Factors underlying migration

The extent and nature of migration in any society is basically determined by the nature of the development process experienced by that society. That is, the type and scale of development achieved by the agricultural and industrial sectors in an economy would determine the migratory patterns.

In India and Tamil Nadu, though the agricultural and industrial sectors have grown over the years, inequalities still exist in asset and income distribution. Endemic poverty continues to be a major problem.



The growth processes have also created spatial inequalities, by leading to enclaves of growth. The migration patterns observed in a developing society such as ours correspond to these inequalities (economic, social, spatial etc) created by the development processes.

Therefore, any migrant stream would consist of heterogeneous sub-streams. For example, if we consider the rural-urban migrant stream, it would comprise of rural rich and the rural poor, each with its own reasons and motivation for migration, the mode of migration, the outcome or consequence of migration etc. Poorer sections of the population migrate as a survival strategy, in response to distressing conditions in rural areas. Migrants from better-off sections migrate to improve their living standards.

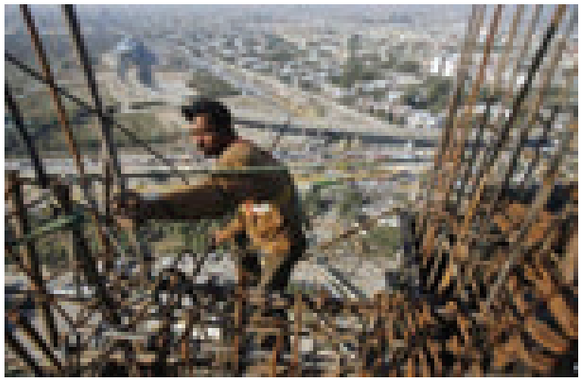
Further, spatially, there would be a tendency for migrants to converge on enclaves of growth-either in urban areas or in rural areas.

The pattern of migration is very complex, comprising of a number of streams:

- rural to rural; rural to urban; urban to rural; urban to urban
- short, medium and long distance migration streams
- long-term stable migration and short-term circulatory type of movements

Each of these streams would consist of different types of migrants, (from different social classes) each with its own reason for migration. The extent and nature of these migrant streams would essentially depend on.

- pressures and aspirations experienced by people at the origin of migration
- constraints imposed on mobility at the origin of migration
- opportunities at the destination and availability of information regarding these opportunities and
- the cost of migration



Migration for survival

DO YOU KNOW?

- The largest migration corridor in the world in 2010 was Mexico – U.S.A.
- The Arctic tern has the longest migration distance of any bird in the world.

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